METHOD CHAINING

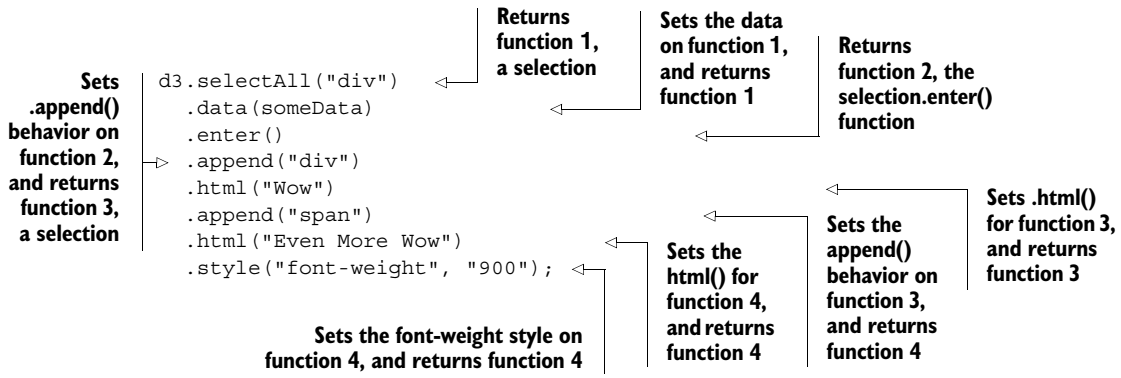
D3 examples, like many examples written in JavaScript, use method chaining extensively. Method chaining, also known as function chaining, is facilitated by returning the method itself with the successful completion of functions associated with a method. One way to think of method chaining is to think of how we talk and refer to each other. Imagine you were talking to someone at a party, and you asked about another guest:

"What's her name?"
"Her name is Lindsay."
"Where does she work?"
"She works at Tesla."
"Where does she live?"
"She lives in Cupertino."
"Does she have any children?"
"Yes, she has a daughter."
"What's her name?"

Do you think the answer to that last question would be "Lindsay"? Of course not. You'd expect the answer to refer to Lindsay's daughter, even though all the previous questions referred to Lindsay. Method chaining is like that. It returns the same function as long as you use getter and setter methods of that function, and returns the new function when you call a method that creates something new. Method chaining is used a lot in D3 examples, which means you'll see something like this written on one line or formatted (but functionally identical) to something written on multiple lines:

```
d3.selectAll("div").data(someData).enter().append("div").html("Wow").append("
     span").html("Even More Wow").style("font-weight", "900");
```

That line is the same as the following code. The only change is in the use of line breaks, which JavaScript ignores:



You could write each line separately, declaring the different variables as you go, and achieve the same effect. That might make more sense if you haven't been exposed to method chaining before.